

Board of Works March 18, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=exBuQ7PqcTw
Publication Date	2026-03-18T13:21:56Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: March 18, 2026

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting of the Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety to order at [00:00:07](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Ted Baker, Will Overmeier, Alan Wiser (Presiding officer/Board members).
 - **Absent:** None noted.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:11](#). A lighthearted opening remark was shared regarding Indiana weather [00:00:33](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the March 11th meeting were approved by voice vote ([00:01:05](#)).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:23 Register of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented claims totaling \$739,602.30. Notable items included IT expenses (CS current yearly email hosting), monthly utility claims to Indiana Michigan Power for traffic signals and street lights, and healthcare claims. A brief discussion occurred regarding an \$11,000 animal shelter claim for low-cost spay and neuter services, clarified as a cumulative total rather than a fixed contract amount.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:02:47**.
- **00:02:54 Noise Exemption Authorization: Ball State University Housing (Outdoor Music Festival)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jacob Mensah (Graduate Assistant / Assistant Residence Learning Coordinator)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The event is the 4th annual "Equinox Music Festival" scheduled for April 11, 2026, from 4:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m. at Botwin Hall. It will feature six bands performing 30-minute sets with 10-minute transitions, using audio equipment provided by Quest Audio. The event has approval from Ball State Police and Housing and Residence Life.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:04:55**.
- **00:05:08 Noise Exemption Authorization: Ball State University Late Night Carnival**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board introduced item (long-running annual event).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The annual late-night carnival is scheduled for April 17, 2026, drawing thousands of attendees. The board noted historical precedent and verified that all standard approvals were in place.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:05:59**.
- **00:06:10 Noise Exemption Authorization: Cobra Firing Systems & Illumination Fireworks (CobraCon / Elevate)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle Struble (Brook and Struble)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Marking the 6th year of the event (rebranded from CobraCon to Elevate), bringing over 500 people for a trade show and pyrotechnic demonstrations at the fairgrounds. Schedule: April 8 (3 PM<U+2013>5 PM, training), April 9 (1 PM<U+2013>3 PM, training), April 10 (8 PM<U+2013>8:30 PM, demonstration), and April 11 (8 PM<U+2013>8:30 PM, demonstration). The fairgrounds will be closed to the public (credential-only access), and emergency services have been notified.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:08:09**.
- **00:08:16 Street Closure Application: Ivy Tech Community College (Fall Kickoff)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Terry Sanders (Ivy Tech Muncie Campus)

- **Deliberation Summary:** Annual campus kickoff event themed around movies ("Lights, camera, you write your own script") scheduled for August 27. Requests closure of Franklin Street (Howard to Adams) and Charles Street (High to Franklin) to accommodate a live band and food trucks.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:09:24](#).
- **00:09:29 Office of Community Development: Amendment to A Better Way Landlord Liaison Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nikita Adams (Office of Community Development)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The existing contract with A Better Way has been operating on annual renewals within a 5-year term. The amendment extends the agreement directly to the end of the full 5-year term to eliminate annual renewals, reflecting satisfaction with the program.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:10:19](#).
- **00:10:26 Economic Development Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Initially unrepresented; later addressed by Mayor / Jeff Howe (Muncie Redevelopment Commission).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Initially tabled at [00:10:41](#) due to the absence of a presenter, the meeting was briefly reopened at [00:11:48](#) upon the arrival of the Mayor. The agreement involves transferring city-owned vacant lots at an effective price to a developer for the construction of market-priced townhome housing. While no direct development funds are provided by the city, the agreement enforces strict penalties (\$5,000 per month for failing to start on time and \$5,000 per month for failing to finish on time).
 - **Properties Included:** 703, 705, 707, 701, and 655 North Mulberry Street; 108, 206, and 208 East Columbus Drive; 701 North Jefferson Street; and 703 <U+00BD> North Elm Street.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Brought to the floor and entered into the public record (no formal vote required/conducted).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:11:13 Ricky Anthony (News Media / Citizen):** Inquired during the initial discussion of the economic development agreement about transparency regarding how taxpayer funds are utilized in economic development projects.
 - **00:13:30 Ricky Anthony (News Media / Citizen):** Spoke again during the reopened economic development discussion to ask specifically which properties were involved, how they connect to the new YMCA development, and what plans exist for the site.
-

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None outside of regular business processing and document signing.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following the conclusion of public comments and discussion at [00:14:41](#).
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-17 02:01:47 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.